

Career Development Policy

Career conversations, internal opportunities, mentoring and progression

Document status: Fictional sample content created for a knowledge-retrieval prototype.

1. Career conversations

Regular conversations between an employee and their manager are the main way career development happens day to day, covering current performance, skills to build, and what the employee wants to do next. These conversations happen alongside, not instead of, any formal performance review process, and are expected a few times a year rather than being left to a single annual meeting.

2. Internal vacancies

Internal vacancies are advertised on the internal jobs page before, or at the same time as, any external advertising, giving existing employees the opportunity to apply first. Employees can apply directly through the internal jobs page; letting the current manager know is expected as a courtesy but is not a requirement before applying. Applications are assessed against the same criteria as external candidates, based on the specific requirements of the role being filled.

3. Mentoring

Employees can request a mentor through the internal mentoring scheme, which pairs them with a more experienced colleague for regular informal conversations about their development, career direction, and specific challenges they are facing. Mentoring is intended as a source of guidance and perspective rather than a formal assessment. Being mentored does not itself form part of the promotion or recruitment process, and taking part is not a requirement for either.

3.1 Becoming a mentor

Any employee with a few years of experience can volunteer to become a mentor through the same scheme. Mentors are matched based on the areas they feel comfortable advising on, rather than being assigned automatically, and there is no obligation to take on more than one mentoring relationship at a time.

4. Promotion

Promotion into a more senior role is based on demonstrated readiness: sustained performance at the higher level, feedback from managers and colleagues, and, for some roles, a specific assessment process. There is no fixed company-wide timetable for promotion - career progression is best discussed regularly with a manager as part of ongoing development rather than tied to a single point in the year.

5. Development records

Managers keep a short informal record of career conversations, agreed development actions, and any mentoring or promotion discussions, so progress can be referred back to at the next conversation rather than reconstructed from memory.